ZIL MONEY / KNOWLEDGE BASE

The Zil Money v4 UI Rebrand and Consistency Pass

A plain-language, phase-by-phase guide to the colour theme, the shared components, and how every screen stays consistent

PRODUCT	WORKSTREAM	AUDIENCE	STATUS
Zil Money web app (v4)	design/zilmoney-rebrand	Design, Dev, QA, PM	In design review

Overview

The v4 UI rebrand and consistency programme re-skins the Zil Money web app to the Zil Money brand and gives it **one colour system, one sizing standard, one button system and one set of component states**, applied the same way on every screen and meeting WCAG 2.2 AA in both themes. It ran on a design branch in seven stages: brand tokens and baseline, palette exploration, screen-by-screen UX passes, accessibility compliance, a consistency pass, a polish pass on the Add Payee modal and Send Payment, and a pass that makes every refused Confirm land on the field that is wrong.

Before the programme, the app carried the Online Check Writer look: legacy blues and a neon green, a mix of fonts, text below 12px, placeholder-only fields, 2.5:1 greys, undersized inputs, and colours typed by hand inside hundreds of components. Dropdowns came in several heights and radii, dark mode turned brand cards into glowing blocks, and busy screens such as Send Payment and the bank account pages carried badges and labels that repeated what the user already knew.

The journey, in plain terms:

- Stage 1: the brand becomes tokens. Inter font, 8px radius, a contrast-verified text scale, 44/40/32px sizing tiers, and a scripted sweep that retires legacy hex values from 388 files.
- Stage 2: the primary colour is explored on real screens. Cerulean, a deep teal, then Slate, then the navy `#004a7c`, with indigo and calm-teal comparison builds kept side by side.
- Stage 3: screen passes. Send Payment, the header launcher, bank accounts, modals, section hub pages and the dashboard are decluttered and compacted, and the rules that came out of review are written down.
- Stage 4: WCAG 2.2 AA. Tokens are fixed first, then components are swept for colour-only status, faint financial copy and unnamed icon buttons. A contrast script guards the result. The bank account card is rebuilt and compliance notices get a calm tone.

- Stage 5: consistency. Dropdown rows, add-new tiles, banners, dividers, modal surfaces and dark-mode brand cards are unified, two long modals are simplified, and the reference, change log and this knowledge base are produced.
- Stage 6: polish. The field border is lightened by decision, dark-mode text is softened, Send Payment gets two field heights and a guided prompt for missing payee details, and the Add Payee modal gets its final entity card, real send-link channel choices and 40px controls throughout. Hand-off files for the Add Payee and Add Customer modal states are produced.
- Stage 7: landing. A review of the International rail finds four cases where a refused Confirm left the user with a dialog and no way to the field. All four are closed, and the screen-order rule now applies to every rail: the page lands on the top-most problem.

FACT	DETAIL
Timeline	Six stages on one design branch: seventeen commits plus working changes, captured as design snapshots 1 to 5.1 in the design-snapshot repository.
Scope	All v4 screens of the Zil Money web app: login, header and sidebar, dashboard, section hub pages, Send Payment, bank accounts, Verification Center, payee, card, category and support modals, wallet and bank lists. About 620 files differ from the staging branch. Classic v3 and v3.5 screens untouched.
Primary palette	Navy primary `#004a7c`, teal accent `#00a5b2`, light-blue page `#f2f7fb`, Inter for all text, 8px radius. Dark mode swaps every token on the same markup.
Accessibility bar	WCAG 2.2 AA app-wide since stage 4: text 4.5:1, control boundaries 3:1, no status by colour alone, financial and consent copy never fainter than body text, a visible keyboard focus ring on every control. A script in the repo checks the token pairs. One documented exception: the field border, lightened to `#d1d5db` in stage 6 at the design owner's request.
Comparison builds	Three local builds that differ only in colour (navy, the earlier indigo, a calm teal) so stakeholders can compare palettes on identical screens. Every change is applied to all three.
Status	Design programme complete on the design branch. Not yet merged. Review pack (UI reference, change log, modal state sheets, this knowledge base) delivered to the dev and QA teams.

How we talk about it (guardrails)

- This is a design-branch pass. Nothing here is live until the dev team merges it through the normal pipeline.
- "Consistent" means the same token and the same recipe, not merely "looks similar".
- The accessibility bar is a hard rule. A softer look never buys its way past a contrast failure. The one exception, the field border, was a named decision and is recorded with its figures.
- Open items are listed honestly. Anything not fixed is named, with the reason.

Knowledge

The master brief. Read this once and you understand everything that changed across the programme, and why.

The programme in full

The work ran in seven stages. Each stage built on the one before, and the rules that came out of review in one stage became the standard for the next.

Stage 1. Brand tokens and the UX baseline

The whole app was re-skinned to the Zil Money brand at the token level so every white-label build changed at once. Inter became the only typeface, the corner radius became 8px, and the text scale was rebuilt so that body, label, helper and placeholder text all clear 4.5:1 on white. A sizing standard was set from live competitor measurement of nine products: **44px for form fields and buttons, 40px for dense toolbars and filters, 32px inside table cells**, with labels always visible at 14px medium, a 2px brand focus ring, and a 12px floor for all text. White-on-brand button text and AA placeholders were set in the shared input and button components. A scripted sweep then replaced legacy brand hex values, low-contrast greys and sub-12px text across 388 files, and a second sweep moved the legacy font variables to Inter in 70 files and put the Slate hero on the v4 login page. On Send Payment the bank account dropdown was decluttered: status pills became a verified icon and an amber Verify link, ACH moved into the detail line, the star shows only for the default or on hover, add-account became a one-line footer, and the account number was masked in the trigger. An attempt to render the page at 100% instead of its 0.85 zoom was reverted the same evening because the result felt bulky; the rule that came out of it is to declutter before enlarging. The design spec for the rebrand lives in the repo under `docs/superpowers/specs`.

Stage 2. Choosing the primary colour

The brand guide's Cerulean was tried first. A deep teal `#145e68` from the colour recommendation was previewed on the sidebar, header, dashboard and Send Payment in light mode. Slate `#415a80` was then adopted app-wide for buttons, links, focus and selection (white text 7.0:1; dark fill `#4f6b96`), with the Cerulean literals swept by script. The main copy then moved to the navy `#004a7c` with a light-blue page, and two comparison builds were created as git worktrees that share every layout change but keep a different palette: the earlier indigo `#20319d` on a pink-tinted page, and a calm teal `#0f766e` on warm off-white, inspired by how competitors sit one restrained accent on a neutral canvas. A sync script keeps all three identical apart from colour; every later change was applied to all three.

Stage 3. Screen passes

- **Header.** A "+" quick-actions launcher at the start of the top bar, with favourites inside its panel and pinned favourite chips right after it. The gold favourite star colour became a token used by every star. "Pin to header" became "Pin to the top bar (next to +)" with an explainer line, and per-tile descriptions were rewritten in plain English as tooltips that search also matches. A standalone gold Favourites button was tried next to "+" and removed on review so the header keeps a single launcher.
- **Sidebar.** Solid primary fill restored on the selected item.
- **Bank accounts.** The stat boxes and full-width buttons of "All Bank Accounts" became one compact 64px summary strip so the table sits higher; the Transactions heading moved into the table toolbar (a new left-side toolbar slot on the shared data table) with a tighter section gap; the Edit Bank Account modal was regrouped into sections; the detail panel gained Account and Info tabs.

- **Send Payment.** First-view compaction, one-line account rows, taller dropdown panels, a compact bank verification modal (icon-and-text intro row, 24px padding, one-line hint instead of the boxed Recommended panel, same trim on its success, error, pending and empty states), and the rule that a verified account shows a tick and a short "ACH" chip, never the word "Verified".
- **Modals app-wide.** A compact dialog rhythm rule in the shared modal stylesheet and unified labels; payee and card modals brought onto the shared recipe; softer field strokes.
- **Section hub pages and dashboard.** Section-page cards and banner rebalanced, the CTA banner moved onto the primary colour, dashboard wallet and upcoming-payment cards, and a light-blue page background throughout.
- **Verification Center.** Re-laid on the shared cards with the current step in focus.

Stage 4. WCAG 2.2 AA and the bank account card

A compliance requirement made AA the app-wide bar. The audit measured 18 of 26 token pairs passing in light mode and 19 of 26 in dark. The fix went token-first: success green, warning amber and error red were darkened in light mode and lightened in dark, the error and sky badge text tokens were corrected, the favourite star darkened to `#b98900`, and the field border moved from a 1.5:1 grey to `#7c8fa3` at 3.3:1. Those changes repaired roughly 1,300 usages at once. A component sweep then followed: brand text on dark surfaces switched to the bold token, green and red fills kept AA-safe shades under white text, status dots gained words and accessible names, about 260 icon-only buttons gained accessible names from their tooltips, primary buttons lost a teal label override so their white text shows, faint fee, warning and consent copy was raised to body weight, and every V2 control gained a visible keyboard focus ring. A Node script, `tools/contrast-check.mjs`, now checks every audited pair and fails on any regression. The spec and task plan live in the repo under `docs/superpowers`.

In the same stage the bank account detail card was rebuilt: the Info tab was merged into Account, balance and nickname became labelled grid items, the second and third information tiers became one aligned definition grid, the top-right button cluster was dropped in favour of a single pencil beside the name, account and routing numbers gained copy buttons with a brief tick, and the holder address renders on one line without stray commas. The Verification Center then gained an action-required panel for compliance cases (enhanced due diligence, re-verification, missing details) built from the same signals as the header badges. On review the red "Action needed" treatment was rejected as too strong for optional requests, so cases carry a severity: re-verification and missing-details notices are neutral and never red, only enhanced due diligence (which has a deadline) uses amber and reopens the business step, and the success family moved to emerald across the app.

Stage 5. Consistency

With the palette and the bar settled, this stage made every screen use the same recipe. Hand-typed indigo on the Bulk Payment Center became white tints and tokens and its "Coming Soon" badge a translucent white pill; the brand surfaces gained a dark-mode navy; feature icon tiles lost the slate accent; the CTA banner button became the teal fill; the Accounts page wallet intro became a shared, compacted component (and was removed from the dashboard on request); the Instant Demo, Add Category and Add payee modals were simplified; the wallet list matched the bank and card lists; the Send Payment dropdowns were unified in row, mask and add-new tile; a missing hover token was defined; and a read-only audit of buttons, dropdowns, modals, tables and states produced a fixed list and an open list. A lighter field border was tried and reverted the same day because it failed the 3:1 check. The UI reference (with ten live style samples), the change log and this knowledge base were written.

Stage 6. Polish on Send Payment and the Add Payee modal

- **Field border, by decision.** The light field border moved from `#7c8fa3` to `#d1d5db`, one shade above the staging grey, after `#8395a8` and `#8a9bad` read too heavy and `#e5e7eb` a touch too faint. It measures 1.47:1 on white, so the 3:1 boundary rule is knowingly not met for field borders; the contrast script records it as a documented exception. Only the colour changed; the dark theme is untouched.
- **Dark mode text.** Main text softened from `#f8fafc` to `#e2e8f0` because bold wallet and account names glared; still 11.9:1 on the card.
- **Send Payment heights.** The four main dropdowns are 44px (from 49px); everything under Additional details is 40px, including its dropdowns, the text inputs on every rail, the receive side, the page modals and the Memo minimum.
- **Missing payee details.** Pressing Confirm with the payee's address, email or company missing opens a calm info prompt that names every gap ("Payee details are missing. This payment needs the payee's address and email address.") with Add details and Not now; Add opens the payee editor on that section and walks through the remaining gaps after each save. A bug was fixed on the way: a missing email failed the form first, so the prompt never ran on the bank, wallet and card rails. The nudge under the payee names every gap in the error colour with an underlined Add now (tried neutral, changed to red on request); the payment-details panel notice stays neutral.
- **Add Payee modal, entity card.** Business shows the address fields inline under Company Name, all required, and the Address chip leaves the optional row; Individual keeps the optional chip and its label reads "Company Name (optional)". Payee ID moved from More info to the Entity card. The entity explanation became a tooltip on an info icon so the card stays one line. Every control renders at the 40px compact height so Email and Phone match; the optional-details chips got their own edge colour so they stay visible against the lighter field border.
- **Add Payee modal, secure link.** A real checkbox beside Email and beside Mobile number, both ticked by default, means "send here once this is filled in"; it unticks itself if the value is invalid and sends nothing over an empty field. "Request to add bank account" now starts checked for every payee type. The hint is a brand-tinted note and "Back to manual entry" an outline pill, with tighter spacing.
- **Hand-off files.** A standalone HTML sheet of the Add Payee modal in ten states with a light and dark toggle, and a five-page PDF of the Add Customer modal states rendered from it.

Stage 7. A refused Confirm lands on the field

A review of the International rail asked one question: when Confirm Payment Details is refused, does the user always end up on the thing that is wrong? Mostly yes. Required fields were already focused and shaken with a message, missing payee details already got a calm prompt, and a bad payee phone already opened the editor. Four cases did not. With no exchange rate the summary modal still opened, and only after Confirm did a dialog say the payment could not be priced. An unresolved transaction limit repeated the limit card's message in a dialog. The purpose category and the payee's stored email had no field to land on, so the page shook the payee row with no word on why. And with several empty fields the page went to whichever control was declared first in the form, which could sit below another empty field.

All four were closed. No exchange rate now stops Confirm before the modal, with a red line under the recipient block that says what to check. An unresolved limit scrolls to the limit card, which already holds the message and the Edit amount button. The purpose category points at the Purpose field. A stored email that fails the check gets the same calm prompt as a missing one, with Update email opening the editor. And every rail now collects all invalid controls and lands on the top-most one in document order, working down

the page one Confirm at a time; this came with the pass's first unit test, since the repo has no test runner wired yet. The card rail's minimum amount was checked and is already caught inline; the two remaining dialogs ("cannot be saved as a draft", "payee temporarily restricted") stay, because there is no field to land on. The rule is recorded in the UI reference as "Blocked submit: where the user lands". A review screenshot then caught the new email prompt firing with no payee selected, a dead end with nothing to update; it now fires only for a selected payee whose stored email has a value that fails, with its own spec, and that case leads the QA matrix.

What changed, screen by screen

SCREEN	CHANGE ACROSS THE PROGRAMME
Login	Rebranded hero on the brand surface; Inter; new field and button sizes.
Header and sidebar	"+" launcher with favourites inside; pinned chips; plain-English tiles; solid selected item; gold favourite stars on tiles (darkened for contrast); named icon buttons and expand/collapse states for screen readers.
Dashboard	Wallet and upcoming-payment cards; Bulk Payment Center on tokens with teal main action and a white "Coming Soon" pill; dark-mode navy surface.
Section hub pages	Cards and banner rebalanced; CTA banner on the primary, then on the dark-aware banner token with a teal button; icon tiles on primary, sky and teal only; Accounts page wallet intro as a shared compact component.
Send Payment	Compact first view; one-line account rows; masked trigger; verified tick and ACH chip; dropdowns on one recipe with a four-dot mask and a dashed add-new tile; 44px main dropdowns and 40px Additional details; guided prompt when payee details are missing; a refused Confirm lands on the top-most field that is wrong, with no exchange rate and transaction limits handled inline on the International rail.
Bank accounts	Summary strip; toolbar heading; Edit modal regrouped; Account and Info merged into one card with labelled grid, single pencil, copy buttons and one-line address; compact verification modal; named status dots.
Verification Center	Shared step cards; action-required panel for compliance cases; calm, neutral re-verification requests; amber reserved for enhanced due diligence.
Modals	Compact rhythm and unified labels; payee modal restructured with an entity chooser, inline business address, optional-details chips, 40px controls and real send-link channel choices; Add Category on one surface; Instant Demo primary action by availability.
Lists	Wallet list dividers and selection rail matched to bank and card lists.
Dark mode	Every token swapped on the same markup; brand text uses the bold token; green and red fills stay AA-safe under white text; banner navy; softened main text; status chips stay light.

SCREEN	CHANGE ACROSS THE PROGRAMME
Global	Tokens for every colour; text, badge and status tokens AA-compliant; sizing tiers; focus ring on every control; dropdown radius; hover token; checkbox and radio states; contrast script with one documented exception (field border).

Decisions that became rules

DECISION	RULE FROM IT
100% zoom felt bulky (stage 1)	Declutter first. Remove repeated badges, icons and labels before making anything bigger.
Slate, then navy primary (stage 2)	One primary for buttons, links, focus and selection; comparison palettes live in separate builds, never mixed on a screen.
Verified shown twice (stage 3)	A tick icon with an accessible name means verified. The short "ACH" chip marks ACH-enabled accounts. The word "Verified" is never a badge.
Every change to all three builds (stage 2)	Make the change in the main copy, verify, then sync to the indigo and teal worktrees so they differ only in colour.
Favourites button removed (stage 3)	The header has one launcher. Favourites live inside the "+" panel.
AA app-wide (stage 4)	Contrast is a hard rule. Fix tokens first, then sweep components. A brand colour is not an exemption.
Red re-verification rejected (stage 4)	Compliance requests are calm and neutral. Only enhanced due diligence may use amber. Success is emerald.
Same recipe everywhere (stage 5)	Rows, tiles, banners and dividers share one class string per component, so a change lands once.
Field border lightened knowingly (stage 6)	Containers use the light card border; fields use `#d1d5db`. This is the one accepted boundary-contrast exception, recorded in the contrast script, and is not to be re-raised as a defect.
Two field heights on Send Payment (stage 6)	The main choices are 44px; everything under Additional details is 40px. Heights follow importance, not component type.
Missing details get a prompt, not a shake (stage 6)	A blocked submit explains itself in words, names every gap, and offers the fix in one click. The inline nudge may be red; the dialog stays calm.
Explain in a tooltip, not a subtitle (stage 6)	Cards stay one line. Explanations live behind an info icon that is keyboard-focusable.
Alert with no way to the field (stage 7)	A refused submit never ends in a bare dialog. Open the panel, scroll, focus, shake, explain. Land on the top-most problem. A dialog only where there is no field, and then it offers the fix.

Who benefits

For users: one calm product in light and dark, fields and buttons large enough to use, text that can be read, status that is never colour alone, a blocked payment that says what is missing and how to fix it, and busy screens stripped of repeated labels.

For the team: a new screen can be built from the reference without a design review for the basics. A colour change is a token edit. The contrast script catches regressions. The audit's open items are a ready-made backlog. The modal state sheets give QA a visual target per state.

Internal FAQ

- *Which palette is final?* The navy `#004a7c` is the main copy. Indigo and calm teal exist as comparison builds for the management decision.
- *Why Inter everywhere?* The brand guide specifies it, and one typeface removed a mix of legacy fonts.
- *Why teal on the banner buttons when white text on teal is about 3:1?* Chosen on review for brand reasons. It is a deliberate exception and is recorded as such.
- *Why did the field borders get darker in the accessibility stage and lighter again in the polish stage?* The original grey measured 1.5:1 and the boundary rule needs 3:1, so the accessibility pass darkened it. On review the darker edge read as heavy, and after four candidates the design owner chose `#d1d5db` knowing it does not meet 3:1. The contrast script records that exception so it is visible, not hidden. Container borders stayed light throughout.
- *Why are there checkboxes in the send-link form again?* The checkboxes removed in the consistency stage only mirrored whether a field was valid and could not be operated. The ones added in the polish stage are real choices, ticked by default, that let a user keep an email on file without sending the link there.
- *What happens when Confirm Payment Details is refused on an international payment?* The page takes the user to the field: a required field is focused and shaken with its message; missing or unusable payee details get a calm prompt that opens the editor; no exchange rate or an unresolved transaction limit scrolls to the message inline. The confirmation modal opens only once everything passes.
- *Is any of this in production?* No. It is on the design branch and in the three comparison builds. Classic v3 and v3.5 screens were not touched.

Definition of success

The Knowledge phase is done when any designer or developer can read this pack and the UI reference, name the token, size tier or recipe for a given element without asking, explain the seven stages and the rules that came out of them, and list the exceptions and why they exist.

BA

Objective

Agree how we will know the rebrand and consistency pass worked, in measurable terms, before it ships.

Investigation and analysis

Most of the value here is qualitative, so the measures lean on things that can be counted in the codebase and in review, with a small set of user-facing checks after release.

Thinking seed

- Count of hand-typed hex colours in v4 templates and styles. The baseline before this pass was in the dozens; the target is zero outside documented exceptions.
- Count of distinct dropdown and button recipes in the v4 app. The audit found several of each; the target is one per component.
- Contrast script result: every token pair passes, every build, as a gate, with the field border listed as the one accepted exception.
- Guardrail: no regression in form completion on Send Payment and Add payee after the modal restructure and the missing-details prompt.
- Guardrail: zero accessibility defects raised against focus visibility, icon-button names or colour-only status.
- Signal: fewer payments blocked at Confirm for missing payee data, now that the prompt walks the user to the fix.

Working strategy

Record the baseline counts from the audit, keep the contrast script in the pipeline, and schedule one post-release review of the two restructured modals and the Send Payment prompt with support tickets as the signal.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the counts above have a baseline, a target and an owner, the contrast gate is agreed, and the post-release review is on the calendar.

To Do

Objective

Turn the design-branch work into merge-ready, reviewable pieces.

Investigation and analysis

The branch holds roughly 620 changed files, most of them from the token sweeps and the accessibility pass. They split naturally into: tokens and global styles, shared components, page-level changes, modal restructures, Send Payment behaviour, and documentation.

Thinking seed

- Which slice can merge first with the lowest risk? Tokens and global style fixes change the look everywhere but touch few files.
- Which changes alter behaviour rather than style? The Add payee restructure, the send-link defaults (channels and bank request on by default), the Send Payment missing-details prompt and gate order, and the Verification Center severity model are the ones to review as features, with tests.
- What is the Definition of Done for a style change: contrast script green, lint clean, screens clicked through in light and dark.

Working strategy

Open one pull request per slice, in the order tokens, global styles, shared components, pages, modals, Send Payment behaviour, docs. Link the change log section for each. Flag the behavioural changes for QA.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the branch is split into reviewable pull requests with acceptance criteria, the behavioural changes are flagged, and the Definition of Done is agreed.

UI/UX

This is the phase that carries the full design depth. The rules below are the ones every other phase relies on.

Colour theme

Brand

- Primary `#004a7c` (dark `#1d6aa5`)
- Brand text in dark mode `#8ec5ec`
- Teal accent `#00a5b2` (both modes)
- Brand banner, dark mode `#0c3d63`
- Favourite star `#b98900` (dark `#ffc83d`)

Surfaces

- Page `#f2f7fb` (dark `#162034`)
- Card and input `#ffffff` (dark `#1c293c`)
- Container border `#e5e7eb` (dark `#3a3e47`)
- Field border `#d1d5db` (dark `#6b7a90`), documented exception

Text

- Main `#111827` (dark `#e2e8f0`)
- Secondary `#374151`
- Tertiary `#4b5563`
- Subtle and placeholder `#6b7280`

Status

- Success `#047857` on `#d1fae5` (emerald)
- Warning `#a16207` on `#fef9c2`
- Error `#b91c1c` on `#ffe2e2`
- Info `#004a7c` on `#e6eff6`

> **Rules.** Containers use the container border; only form fields use the field border, which is the one accepted boundary-contrast exception. Status chips stay light in dark mode. Compliance notices are neutral, never red; only enhanced due diligence is amber. Verified bank accounts show a tick and a short "ACH" chip, never the word "Verified". Status is never colour alone: every dot and icon carries a word or an accessible name.

Buttons

VARIANT	RECIPE
Primary	Navy fill, white text, 44px, 14px semibold, 8px radius. One per view or modal. The label is never recoloured.
Outline	White fill, 2px navy border, brand text (bold token in dark mode). The Cancel and secondary action.
Destructive	Red fill, white text. Confirm dialogs only.
Compact	32px, 13px, 4px radius. Toolbars, cards, table actions.
On brand surfaces	Main action is the teal fill with white text; supporting actions are a 15% white tint with a 30% white border.
Icon-only	Always carries an accessible name, taken from its tooltip when it has one.

VARIANT	RECIPE
States	Hover darkens 8% and lifts; keyboard focus shows a 2px brand ring with 2px offset; active presses to 98%; disabled is 45% opacity and desaturated; loading disables the button and spins a 16px icon after the label.

Component states

- **Fields:** 44px by default, 40px compact inside modals and under Send Payment's Additional details, 32px in table cells; field border, brand border plus ring on focus, red border and a shaking message on error after the field is touched, 50% opacity when disabled, red asterisk for required, "(optional)" in the label otherwise.
- **Dropdowns:** 44px control (40px in the compact tier), 12px radius, brand border on hover and when open, 2px brand border once a value is chosen, 12px panel with 44px rows and a 240px scroll height. In modals the panel attaches to the body so it never clips.
- **Choice rows:** 28px icon tile that fills navy when selected, 13px bold name with the masked number beside it ("•••• 1234"), page-tint hover, brand-tint selection, 3px gap between rows, dashed green "Add new" tile at the top.
- **Modals:** 20px shell, one surface for header, body and footer, title 20px semibold with a 12px subtitle, close icon top right, Cancel outline then primary at 120px each.
- **Blocked submit:** the page opens the collapsed panel if the problem is inside it, scrolls to the top-most invalid field, focuses it, shakes it and shows its message; controls with no field of their own point at the field that drives them. A centred info dialog is used only where there is no field (payee record gaps), and it names every gap with one action that leads to the fix and a Not now. Never a silent refusal, a shake alone, or a dialog with no way to the field.
- **Empty:** one white card with a 60px icon circle, 18px title, one helper line and one compact primary action. Never a fake list skeleton.
- **Loading:** shimmer skeletons for tables and panels, a spinning icon inline, a full-screen blurred overlay only for whole-page waits.
- **Feedback:** centred alert dialogs for success, failure, info and warning; inline banners on the success, warning and error surfaces; no toasts.

Simplicity patterns from this pass

- Required fields in one card. A clear, separate choice (Individual or Business) with pill buttons, explained in a tooltip rather than a subtitle. The choice moves fields: a business's address sits inside the card, an individual's behind an optional chip.
- Optional sections as a single row of dashed chips, opened one at a time, with a tick once completed and a red "Required" tag when a choice makes them mandatory.
- Controls that only mirror derived state are removed and replaced with a status line. Where a real choice exists, it is a labelled checkbox beside the field, on by default, as with the send-link channels.
- Heights follow importance: the primary choices on a page are 44px, supporting details 40px.
- A blocked action explains itself and offers the fix in one click.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every v4 element can be traced to a token and a recipe in the UI reference, dark mode is reviewed on every changed screen, and the deliberate exceptions are listed with their contrast figures.

Compliance Sign-off

Objective

Confirm the pass changes nothing about what data is collected or shown, and that accessibility obligations are met.

Investigation and analysis

The restructured Add payee modal moves fields around but collects the same data. The send-link form now has real per-channel checkboxes, ticked by default, and the "request bank account" option starts checked for every payee type, so a secure link asks for bank details unless the user unticks it. The Send Payment prompt asks for data the payment already required; it only surfaces the gap earlier and in words. No new personal data is captured and no masking was weakened: account numbers are still shown as the last four digits only, and the Verification Center lists the documents each compliance case needs up front.

Thinking seed

- Does the four-dot mask beside the name reveal anything the previous format did not? It shows the same last four digits.
- Does the Individual or Business choice change which fields are required in a way Legal needs to know? It makes company name and address required for a business, as before; the address now sits inside the card.
- Is "request bank account" on by default acceptable for every payee type, or should any type start unticked?
- Is the field-border exception acceptable to cite in an accessibility audit alongside the figures?

Working strategy

Walk Compliance through the two restructured forms and the Send Payment prompt with before-and-after screenshots and the modal state sheets, confirm no change to data capture, consent or masking, note the new defaults, and attach the contrast report with its one exception.

Definition of success

The phase is done when Compliance confirms no change to data collection or exposure, accepts the send-link defaults, and the accessibility evidence is accepted.

Development

Objective

Merge the design-branch work safely, keep the token system as the single source of colour, and leave the codebase easier to extend.

Investigation and analysis

The concrete surfaces engineering will touch: the light and dark theme files and the theme emitter that turns them into CSS variables; the Tailwind config that maps those variables to utility classes; the global overrides file for dropdowns, checkboxes, radios, the dark-mode text rules and the focus ring; the shared button (new `ariaLabel` input and spec), input, dropdown, data table and main-page layout components; the page data file that assigns icon colours to feature tiles; the Send Payment send component, its state service and the bank, wallet and card payment services (gate order and the missing-details prompt); the dropdown shell (`barHeight` input); the field-focus helpers (`invalid-fields.ts`, with the first spec) and the send state's focus request, now a list of keys; the bank details card; the Verification Center (severity model and the new action-required component); and the Add payee, Add Category and Instant Demo modal components. The shared wallet intro component, the contrast script, the two superpowers specs and plan, and the design-system docs folder are additions.

Thinking seed

- Keep the three colour builds in step. Every change goes to the main copy, then the sync script re-applies it to the other two with their colour swap.
- The field-border exception is encoded in the contrast script with its floors. Do not "fix" the border back to 3:1 without a decision.
- The dropdown height tiers exist twice. Decide which set survives and delete the other before more screens are added.
- Forty hand-rolled primary buttons remain in twenty-four files. Migrate them to the shared button in a dedicated pull request.
- Modal shells are repeated by hand in over a hundred templates. A shared shell component would retire most of the remaining inconsistency.
- The error message component still uses a FontAwesome icon; the repo standard is Lucide.
- The missing-payee check must stay ahead of the form check on every rail, or the prompt silently stops firing again.
- The repo has no unit-test target wired (no Karma or Jasmine, no test entry in the Angular config) although the contributor guide says `npm test` runs Karma. The new spec runs through esbuild and a small Node runner until that is fixed; wiring `ng test` makes it run as-is.

Working strategy

Merge in slices as planned in To Do, run the contrast script and lint on each, click through light and dark for every touched screen, and keep the UI reference and change log current as part of the pull request.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the slices are merged, no v4 screen carries a hard-coded colour outside documented exceptions, the contrast gate is green, and the docs match what shipped.

QA Scheduled

Objective

Prove that every Send Payment journey still works end to end after the pass, in both themes. The main criterion is simple: **nothing breaks**. No modal dead-ends, no refused Confirm without a way to the field, no journey that worked before and does not now. The fixes change behaviour only where a journey was broken; the look of the page does not change anywhere else, and any visual difference found is a defect.

Investigation and analysis

The pass touched the shared submit path, so every rail is in scope, not only International. The behavioural changes are the Add payee modal (entity choice, inline business address, optional chips, send-link channels and bank request on by default), the Send Payment missing-details prompts, the screen-order landing on every rail, the International no-rate and limit handling, the Verification Center severity model, and the Instant Demo modal (primary action depends on expert availability). The modal state sheets in the design-system folder are the visual targets for the Add payee and Add customer modals; the UI reference section "Blocked submit: where the user lands" is the behavioural target for Send Payment.

One break was found in review during the pass and fixed before hand-off: with no payee selected, Confirm on the International rail opened the "Payee email address needs attention" prompt, and its Update email button had no payee to open, a dead end. The prompt now fires only for a selected payee whose stored email has a value that fails; with no payee, Confirm lands on the payee field. QA re-checks that exact case first.

Thinking seed

The Send Payment matrix. Run every row on every rail: bank account (ACH, same-day ACH, wire, RTP, check by mail, print and email, let the payee choose), card, and wallet (ACH, wire, check, international, virtual card).

- **Empty form, Confirm**: lands on the amount, no dialog. **Only the payee missing**: lands on the payee field, no prompt. **Two or more empty fields**: the top-most is focused first, the next Confirm moves down.
- **Payee selected with a gap** (email, address, company; several at once): the calm prompt names every gap; Add opens the editor on the right section; after save the form re-reads and asks for the next gap; Not now returns to the payee field. **Payee with a malformed stored email**: the "needs attention" prompt; Update email opens the editor on the email page. **Payee with an invalid phone (international)**: the alert with Update opens the phone page.
- **Additional details collapsed with an error inside**: the panel opens and the field is focused. **Wallet balance short**: the wallet field. **Bank account not verified**: the verification modal, and Confirm resumes after it.
- **International**: Confirm with no exchange rate (inline message, no modal), while the rate is loading (inline "still getting" message), with a hard limit shown (scrolls to the limit card), after a soft-limit Proceed and after a soft-limit Cancel (Edit amount opens), amount under $10, no destination currency, no recipient bank.
- **Every modal the page opens**: Confirm Payment Details, the payee editor on each page, add bank account, bank verification, add international bank, check details, recurring, notify payee, attachments,

comments, remittance, transaction history, compliance freeze, OTP and 3DS. Each must open, do its job, close, and hand control back to the form. A primary button that does nothing is a blocker.

- **Save as well as Confirm**, and **edit or clone of an existing payment**, on each rail.
- **Theme and keyboard**: every case in light and dark, including the new inline rate message and the softened dark text; a keyboard-only run through the entity pills, info tooltip, optional chips, send-link checkboxes and dropdown rows, with the focus ring visible at every stop and every icon-only button announcing a name.
- **No visual drift**: compare each screen with the reference screenshots and the state sheets; spacing, radius, height, hover and selection must match outside the four fixes.

Working strategy

Write one case per cell of the matrix, pair each with the expected landing or screenshot, run on the main build and on one comparison build, and assign a tester and a date. Log any dead-end modal or alert-with-no-way-to-the-field as a blocker, not a cosmetic defect.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every rail has its matrix written with expected landings, the dead-end case found in review is on the list, the keyboard and theme runs are scheduled, and the "nothing breaks, no visual change outside the fixes" criterion is agreed as the exit bar.

In QA

Objective

Run the matrix and prove that no Send Payment journey breaks and no screen drifted from the reference.

Investigation and analysis

Two kinds of defect. A **break**: a modal whose button does nothing, a prompt that appears when it should not (such as with no payee selected), a refused Confirm that ends in a dialog with no way to the field, a journey that cannot be completed. A **drift**: spacing, radius, height, hover or selection that differs from the reference screenshots or the state sheets, even when the colour is right. Breaks are blockers; drifts are defects against the change log entry they relate to.

Thinking seed

- Does every Add, Update and Edit amount button open the right editor or panel, and does the form read the result back?
- Does Not now always return focus to a field, never leave the user looking at a closed dialog?
- Does the Confirm Payment Details modal open only once everything passes, on every rail?
- Does a dropdown panel inside a modal ever clip at the modal edge?
- Does the Add payee modal still submit correctly for each payee type and entity choice, and does the secure link go only to ticked channels?
- Do the three comparison builds behave identically, differing only in colour?

Working strategy

Execute the matrix rail by rail, light then dark, log breaks as blockers and drifts against their change log entry, and re-test every fix in both themes and on one comparison build.

Definition of success

The phase is done when every cell has passed in both themes, no blocker is open, and no open drift touches a changed screen.

09 | QA Passed

QA Passed

Objective

Record that the pass is verified and ready to release.

Investigation and analysis

Collect the evidence: the executed test plan, the contrast report with its documented exception, lint and unit test results (including the shared button spec), and the final screenshots per theme.

Thinking seed

- Is every defect closed or explicitly deferred with an owner?
- Does the UI reference still match the verified screens?

Working strategy

Attach the evidence to the epic and update the status in the reference document.

Definition of success

The phase is done when QA has signed off with the evidence attached and the reference reflects the verified state.

Deployment

Objective

Ship the merged slices through the normal pipeline with a clean way back.

Investigation and analysis

Style changes are low risk individually but highly visible together. Shipping tokens first changes the look everywhere at once; shipping pages first leaves a mixed state. Tokens and global styles should go together, then the rest. The send-link defaults and the Send Payment prompt change behaviour and deserve their own release note.

Thinking seed

- Does the white-label build for every brand still look right? A shared token change reaches all of them.
- Is the rollback a plain revert of the merge, with no data or config to undo?
- Is dark mode checked on the deployed build, not only locally?

Working strategy

Deploy slice by slice through the pipeline, check a brand build and both themes after each, and keep the revert path ready.

Definition of success

The phase is done when all slices are deployed, every brand build is checked, and the rollback path is confirmed unused or exercised cleanly.

Sales and Support Training

Objective

Make sure support can answer "the screen looks different" questions calmly and accurately.

Investigation and analysis

The visible changes customers may ask about: the navy and teal look, a darker and calmer dark mode, the shorter Add payee form with the Individual or Business choice, the send-link form with per-channel checkboxes ticked by default and a bank-details request on by default, and a new message on Send Payment when a payee's details are missing.

Thinking seed

- What does a user do if they cannot find the address fields? For a business they are inside the Entity card under Company Name. For an individual they are behind the Address chip under "Add optional details".
- What changed in the send-link form? The link goes to every channel that is filled in and ticked; untick a channel to keep the value without sending there. The link asks the payee for bank details unless "Request to add bank account" is unticked.
- Why does Send Payment say "Payee details are missing"? The payment needs the payee's address, email or company. "Add details" opens the payee editor on the right section; "Not now" returns to the form.
- Nothing about pricing, limits or data handling changed.

Working strategy

Give support a one-page before-and-after with the five visible changes and the answers above.

Definition of success

The phase is done when support has the one-pager and can walk a customer through the Add payee form and the Send Payment prompt without escalation.

Marketing Training

Objective

Align public screenshots and brand assets with the new palette.

Investigation and analysis

Marketing material that shows app screens will look dated once the navy and teal ship. The palette values and the dark-mode rules are in the reference.

Thinking seed

- Which public pages and help articles show the old indigo screens?
- Should dark-mode screenshots be used anywhere? The dark palette is now presentable.

Working strategy

Share the palette card from the reference and a set of refreshed screenshots after deployment.

Definition of success

The phase is done when marketing has the palette and refreshed screenshots, and no live asset shows the retired palette.

Live BA Dashboard Preview

Objective

Show the measures from the BA phase on real data before management sign-off.

Investigation and analysis

The codebase counts (hard-coded colours, distinct recipes) come from a repository scan; the contrast gate comes from the pipeline; the form-completion guardrail and the blocked-at-Confirm signal come from product analytics.

Thinking seed

- Is the hard-coded colour count at zero outside the documented exceptions?
- Has Send Payment or Add payee completion moved since release?
- Is anything presented as live that is still a manual count?

Working strategy

Present the counts and the guardrail trend with their sources, and label anything manual as such.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the measures are shown from their real sources and any gap has a named owner.

Management Approval

Objective

Get an explicit decision that the new look and the consistency rules are the standard going forward.

Investigation and analysis

Management chooses between the three colour builds and confirms the teal accent and the dark-mode navy. The two deliberate contrast exceptions, white text on the teal accent and the `#d1d5db` field border, need an explicit yes.

Thinking seed

- Navy, indigo or teal primary? The comparison builds exist for this decision.
- Is white text on the teal accent accepted as an exception, or should the fill be darkened?
- Is the lighter field border accepted as an exception to the 3:1 boundary rule, with the figures in the contrast report?
- Is the open-items list funded as follow-up work?

Working strategy

Present the three builds on identical screens, the exception list with contrast figures, and the open-items backlog. Record the decisions.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the palette, the exceptions and the follow-up backlog are each decided with a named approver.

Done

Objective

Close the pass with the reference as the living standard.

Investigation and analysis

Confirm the deployed app matches the reference, the change log is complete, and the comparison builds are archived or retired.

Thinking seed

- Is the reference linked from the repo's contributor guide so new screens follow it?
- Are the two worktrees for colour comparison still needed?

Working strategy

Link the docs, retire the comparison builds once the palette is decided, and write the closing summary.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the reference is the linked standard, the comparison builds are retired, and the epic has a written summary.

BA Review

Objective

Check whether the pass achieved its goals and decide what comes next.

Investigation and analysis

Compare the codebase counts and guardrails with the baseline, and review how many new screens since release followed the reference without correction.

Thinking seed

- Did the recipe count stay at one per component, or did new variants creep in?
- Which open items caused real friction and should move up the backlog?
- Does the reference need a section it is missing?

Working strategy

Run the scan again, read the recent screens against the reference, and update the open-items list and the document.

Definition of success

The phase is done when the results are compared with the baseline, the follow-up work is prioritised, and the reference is updated.

Open items carried forward BACKLOG

ITEM	WHY IT IS OPEN
Modal shells	78 of 110 modal headers still use a different surface token; no shared shell component exists yet.
Dropdown height tiers	Two systems coexist (global 44/40 and the mixin 32/38/48/54). One must be deleted.
Hand-rolled buttons	Forty remain across twenty-four files with mixed radius and hover.
Error message icon	Uses FontAwesome; the standard is Lucide.
Empty-field border class	A legacy red border class is applied to empty inputs and only hidden by cascade order.
Legacy grid themes and raw selects	Two old ag-grid themes remain on five grids; country and state selects and three modals use raw ng-select without the shared mixin.
Field border boundary contrast	Set to `#d1d5db` (1.47:1) at the design owner's request; recorded as a documented exception in the contrast script. Needs management sign-off as an exception, not a tweak.
Teal CTA text contrast	White on teal is about 3:1; accepted on review as an exception.

Zil Money v4 UI rebrand and consistency pass. Knowledge base prepared from the design branch, the change log and the UI reference in the repository. Values quoted are the tokens at the end of stage 7.